

Event Planning Report and Proposal

A student hackathon for the 2027 Limerick IT Summit, open to universities and colleges across Ireland, adapted from a completed reference event and updated for current technology, regulation and industry practice

Item	Detail
Prepared by	**Mohit Behl**, Volunteer Coordinator, IT Summit 2027
Audience	IT Summit 2027 organising committee, summit organisers, finale host institution and prospective partners
Version and date	Version 1.2, 4 November 2026
Status	Draft for committee review. Items marked “proposed” or “TBC” need confirmation by the host institution before publication.
Companion files	IT_Summit_2027_Hackathon_Proposal.pptx (committee deck); IT_Summit_2027_Round1_Idea_Template.pptx (participant template)

About the source material

This plan is built on documents from a completed inter-college hackathon in India (the “reference event”): its website (domains, judging panel, IP policy and judging parameters), Round 1 idea-submission guidelines, ideation slide template, a planning report and a participant-journey report.

All names, logos and branding from the reference material have been removed. Where this report quotes the reference event’s approach, it says so; everything else is a proposal for IT Summit 2027.

The host event is the Limerick IT Summit (section 2). Its website could not be opened from the drafting environment, so facts about the summit come from the public coverage listed in Appendix C.

Contents

1. Executive summary
2. The host event: Limerick IT Summit
3. Review of the reference event
4. Why these themes now: technology and regulation, 2025–26
5. Event concept and the Trust Triad
6. Challenge domains
7. Rounds, format and master timeline
8. Grand Finale run-of-show
9. Judging and awards
10. Rules, intellectual property and compliance in Ireland
11. Organisation, workstreams and volunteers
12. Budget and sponsorship framework
13. Risks and contingency plan
14. Participant journey and communications
15. After the event: follow-up and success measures
16. Decisions needed and next steps

Appendix A. Round 1 idea submission guidelines (IT Summit 2027 version)
Appendix B. Logistics and infrastructure checklist
Appendix C. Sources and verification notes

1. Executive summary

IT Summit 2027, the 2027 edition of the Limerick IT Summit (a free, non-profit technology event for SMEs), will add an inter-university hackathon for students at higher-education institutions across Ireland. The plan keeps what worked at the reference event: an online idea round with a fixed slide structure, an equal-weighted judging rubric, a mixed start-up, industry and academic jury, detailed logistics checklists and a 24-hour on-site finale. It adapts these to Irish academic calendars and to EU and Irish regulation, and it takes on the technology issues of 2025–26: generative and agentic AI, ransomware against critical services and their suppliers, large cloud outages, and the energy cost of computing.

What this plan proposes

- **Three rounds:** an online idea submission (Round 1), a one-week online mentored build sprint for shortlisted teams (Round 2), and a 24-hour on-site Grand Finale on the weekend before the summit (planning assumption: Saturday 27 to Sunday 28 February 2027).
- **A bridge to the summit's SME audience:** an SME Challenge Bank of real problems from local businesses, and a showcase at the summit (planning assumption: Thursday 4 March 2027) where the winning teams demo to attendees and an SME Choice award is voted.
- **12 challenge domains:** the reference event's 11 domains, re-scoped for Ireland and the EU, plus a new Domain 12 on optimisation, cloud and resilient systems.
- **The Trust Triad:** every project, in every domain, shows that it is secure, responsible and efficient, using a one-page Trust Card. This is the event's signature feature.
- **A declared-AI policy:** AI coding assistants are allowed, but teams must declare their use, and every member must be able to explain the code.
- **Judging that rewards quality over quantity**, with judge calibration, conflict-of-interest declarations and a clear appeals process.
- **Participant-friendly IP:** teams keep ownership of what they build.
- **A "build-on" pathway** after the event that links winning teams to mentors and to existing Irish start-up supports.

Planning size (assumption to confirm once the venue is known)

Round 1 is open to all eligible teams. Up to **50 teams** go through to Round 2, and **25 to 30 teams (about 100 to 120 students)** reach the Grand Finale.

This size fits one venue and one overnight shift pattern, and it is the basis for the staffing and catering estimates in this report.

2. The host event: Limerick IT Summit

IT Summit 2027 is the 2027 edition of the Limerick IT Summit. The summit's website could not be opened from the drafting environment, so this section relies on public coverage of the 2025 and 2026 editions (Appendix C). The summit organisers should confirm or correct these points.

2.1 What public sources say about the summit

Item	2025 edition	2026 edition
Date	Thursday 6 March 2025	Thursday 26 February 2026

Item	2025 edition	2026 edition
Venue	Dell Technologies campus, Raheen, Limerick	Same campus, with space for over 450 attendees
Theme	Not confirmed (a January 2025 listing used “Your Digitalisation Toolkit”)	“Your AI Toolkit”
Format	Keynotes, panel discussions, networking and an exhibition area	Not found in public coverage
Model	Free to attend; non-profit, with participating companies volunteering their time	Free to attend, with registration on Eventbrite; presented with Limerick City and County Council
Audience	SME owners, sole traders and technology professionals	Same

No 2027 date, venue or theme had been announced by 4 November 2026. No student programme or hackathon appears in coverage of earlier editions, so this hackathon would be a new strand of the summit.

2.2 What this means for the hackathon

What we know about the summit	How the hackathon responds
The audience is SME owners and technology professionals, not students	The hackathon becomes the summit’s bridge between students and local businesses: an SME Challenge Bank of real problems (section 6), and a showcase where SMEs meet the teams (section 8.1).
Its 2026 theme was “Your AI Toolkit”	Projects are framed as tools an SME could use, and finalists are encouraged to publish them as open source so attendees can try them.
It runs on a Thursday in late February or early March	The Grand Finale is held on the weekend before the summit, and the winners present on summit day.
It is free, non-profit and driven by volunteers	Free entry, a lean budget, in-kind sponsorship, and one volunteer team led by the Volunteer Coordinator.
The 2026 venue held over 450 attendees	A compact showcase of about 8 to 10 tables for the winning and special-award teams, subject to space agreed with the organisers.
It is rooted in Limerick and the Mid-West	Outreach starts with Mid-West institutions (University of Limerick, Technological University of the Shannon, Mary Immaculate College) and then goes national; travel bursaries help teams from further away.

2.3 Date assumption

Previous editions were held on Thursday 6 March 2025 and Thursday 26 February 2026. This plan assumes the 2027 summit is on **Thursday 4 March 2027**, with the hackathon Grand Finale on **Saturday 27 and Sunday 28 February 2027**. If the summit date is different, every date in this plan moves by the same amount and the finale stays on the weekend before the summit. If the summit is earlier than late February, Round 1 would need to open before Christmas.

3. Review of the reference event

3.1 What the source material covers

Source	What it covers	How this plan uses it
Event website (three screenshots)	11 challenge domains; final judging panel of start-ups, industry experts and academic leaders; IP shared between students and the host incubator; five judging parameters at 20% each “for all rounds”. The live website itself could not be opened from the drafting environment, so only the screenshots were used.	Domain structure kept and re-scoped; panel mix kept; rubric kept for the online rounds and extended for the finale; IP terms changed (section 10).
Round 1 idea submission guidelines	A 5-slide idea deck (title, problem, solution, innovation, impact); PPT/PPTX/PDF only; 10 MB limit; naming convention; five 20% criteria; notes on plagiarism, visuals and a mixed jury.	Kept and extended to 6 slides with a new “Feasibility and Trust” slide (Appendix A).
Ideation slide template	Five template slides that match the guidelines.	Rebuilt as the IT Summit 2027 Round 1 template (companion file).
Hackathon planning report	Planning areas, logistics, safety and welfare, final week, event-day flow, sample 24-hour schedule, contingency plan, post-event tasks, teams and a T-60 to T+30 master timeline.	Used as the operating backbone of this plan, with dates and Irish adaptations added (sections 7 to 15).
Participant journey report	The participant’s path from discovery to post-event, a four-role team model, tools, logistics and demo contingencies.	Used to design participant communications, the handbook and the support offered at each stage (section 14).
Host event: Limerick IT Summit	Public coverage of the 2025 and 2026 editions (dates, venue, audience, format). The summit website could not be opened from the drafting environment.	Used to align dates, audience and format (section 2).
Shared web links (event website and a share.google link)	Neither could be opened from the drafting environment (network access blocked).	Nothing in this report depends on them. Details from the full website can be added once access is allowed.

3.2 What worked and is kept

- A fixed, short Round 1 deck structure: easy for students to prepare and for judges to compare.
- A simple, transparent rubric: five criteria at 20% each.
- A mixed final jury of start-up founders, industry experts and academic leaders.
- Thorough planning checklists, including a 10 to 15% budget contingency, a waitlist for the expected 15 to 30% no-shows, judge conflict-of-interest and appeals rules, and a hard deadline with a published grace policy.
- Welfare measures: women volunteers on the night shift, a quiet room, scheduled breaks and a named conduct contact.
- A dated post-event plan (T+2, T+14, T+30) with feedback, payments, reports and follow-up for winners.
- Participant-centred guidance: a suggested four-role team, preparation for mentor sessions, and backup screenshots or video for demos.

3.3 Gaps and inconsistencies fixed in this plan

#	What we found	Why it matters	Change for IT Summit 2027
1	The slide limit is given as “5 (including title)” and as “5–7 slides” in the same guideline.	Teams cannot tell what will be penalised.	One limit, stated once: a maximum of 6 slides including the title slide.
2	The technical criterion is “Technical Potential: depth and practicality” in the guideline but “Technical Depth: quantity of architecture/code” on the website.	Quantity rewards bulk rather than quality, and AI tools make bulk easy to produce.	“Technical depth and quality”, scored on a working demo, sound architecture and code quality.
3	In the sample schedule the hard submission deadline (11:00) falls an hour before hacking ends (12:00).	Two different end times invite disputes.	One moment: code freeze and hard deadline together at H+24.
4	Round deadlines are left as “will be updated on the website”.	Students plan around coursework, and late dates cut participation.	All dates are published at launch (section 7).
5	An individual’s personal phone number is given as the contact for queries.	Privacy risk and a single point of failure.	A shared event mailbox and a helpdesk channel staffed by the team.
6	IP is shared between students and the host incubator.	This can deter strong teams, and Irish institutions have their own IP policies.	Teams keep their IP; organisers get a licence to showcase; any sponsor terms are opt-in (section 10.3).
7	Some domains refer to Indian national programmes (a national digital health mission, digital public infrastructure, MSME schemes).	Not meaningful to students, mentors or judges in Ireland.	Re-scoped to Irish and EU equivalents (section 6).
8	No rules on AI tools, security, data protection, accessibility or energy use.	These are now standard industry expectations and, in several cases, EU law.	Declared-AI policy, the Trust Triad and Trust Card, and a Trust criterion in finale judging.

4. Why these themes now: technology and regulation, 2025–26

The domains and the Trust Triad respond to developments that students will meet in their first jobs. Each point below is drawn from the public sources listed in Appendix C, checked on 4 November 2026. Regulatory dates change, so they should be re-checked before participant materials are published.

Trend	What has happened	What it means for the hackathon
AI is now regulated	The EU AI Act (Regulation (EU) 2024/1689) entered into force on 1 August 2024. Prohibited practices have applied since 2 February 2025, rules for general-purpose AI models since 2 August 2025, and transparency duties (Article 50) since 2 August 2026. Under the 2026 “Digital Omnibus” amendments, obligations for stand-alone high-risk systems move to 2 December 2027 and for high-risk AI in regulated products to 2 August 2028.	AI projects state their intended use, data sources and limits, label AI-generated content, and avoid prohibited uses. Domain 1 is framed as “Applied and Trustworthy AI”.

Trend	What has happened	What it means for the hackathon
Ransomware against critical services and their suppliers	Ireland's health service (HSE) was hit by Conti ransomware in May 2021; an independent post-incident review was published in December 2021. In September 2025 a ransomware attack on a third-party check-in and boarding system disrupted Dublin Airport and other European airports.	Security-by-design and supply-chain thinking feature in Domain 6, the Trust Card and the overnight mini-CTF.
Cyber regulation is tightening	Ireland has not yet transposed the NIS2 Directive; the European Commission referred Ireland to the EU Court of Justice in July 2026, and the National Cyber Security Bill is still expected. The EU Cyber Resilience Act's reporting duties for actively exploited vulnerabilities and severe incidents have applied since 11 September 2026, with most other obligations from 11 December 2027.	Teams building connected products (Domains 2, 5 and 7) think about secure updates and vulnerability handling.
Cloud and software fragility	A faulty security-software update on 19 July 2024 affected about 8.5 million Windows devices (Microsoft's estimate). A major AWS outage in the us-east-1 region on 19–20 October 2025 was traced to a race condition in DynamoDB's automated DNS management.	New Domain 12 on optimisation and resilient systems; judges ask about single points of failure; the event's own platform has a tested fallback.
The energy cost of computing	Data centres used 22% of Ireland's metered electricity in 2024, up from 5% in 2015 (CSO). Later CSO figures, reported in 2026, put the 2025 share at 23%.	"Efficient" is one of the three Trust Triad pillars, and there is a Green Code award.
Accessibility is law	The European Accessibility Act has applied in Ireland since 28 June 2025 (S.I. No. 636 of 2023). It covers websites, apps, e-commerce and many other digital services.	Domain 10, plus a basic accessibility check on every user-facing project.
Digital identity and public services	Every EU member state must offer at least one certified EU Digital Identity Wallet by the end of 2026 under eIDAS 2.0.	Domain 4 includes challenges on trustworthy digital public services and verifiable credentials.
EU policy focus	Ireland holds the Presidency of the Council of the EU from July to December 2026, with competitiveness, security and values as its priorities, including AI, data and cyber resilience.	A timely hook for sponsors and public-sector partners.
Securing AI applications	The OWASP Top 10 for LLM Applications (2025) lists prompt injection as the top risk.	A lightning workshop at the finale, and a Trust Card question for LLM-based projects.
Post-quantum cryptography	NIST published its first three finalised post-quantum cryptography standards (FIPS 203, 204 and 205) in August 2024.	An optional advanced challenge in Domain 6.

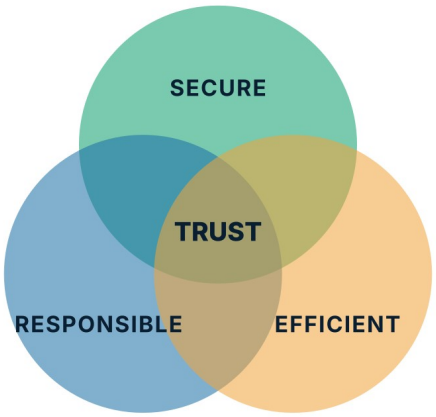
5. Event concept and the Trust Triad

5.1 Event at a glance

Element	Proposal
Working title	IT Summit 2027 Inter-University Hackathon, part of the Limerick IT Summit 2027
Theme line	Build technology people can trust: secure, responsible, efficient
Who can enter	Undergraduate and postgraduate students aged 18 or over, enrolled at a higher-education institution in Ireland, from any discipline. Teams can mix institutions.
Team size	2 to 4 members. The reference event's four-role model is recommended: frontend/UI-UX, backend/database, research/presenter, and team manager/integration.
Format	Hybrid. Rounds 1 and 2 run online; the Grand Finale is a 24-hour on-site event.
Entry fee	Free, in line with the summit, which is free to attend and run on a non-profit basis. Costs are covered by in-kind support and sponsors.
Proposed finale date	Saturday 27 to Sunday 28 February 2027 (planning assumption): the weekend before the summit, which this plan assumes is Thursday 4 March 2027. Clear of semester 1 exams and the St Brigid's Day bank holiday, and well before St Patrick's Day and Easter. All dates move with the confirmed summit date.
Link to the summit	Winning and special-award teams show their projects at the summit and pitch on its main stage, and summit attendees vote for an SME Choice award. Stage time and space are subject to agreement with the summit organisers.
Plan B format	If overnight use of the building is not approved: a two-day format without an overnight stay (Saturday 09:00–21:00 and Sunday 08:00–17:00), with the same rounds and judging.

5.2 The Trust Triad: one baseline for every project

The Trust Triad is the event's main innovation. It is not a separate track. Every project in every domain is expected to show three baseline qualities. Together they are worth 10% of the finale score and are the basis for three special awards.



Pillar	Minimum expectation	Evidence on the Trust Card
Secure	No secrets (passwords, API keys) committed to the repository; authentication wherever personal data is handled; the three most likely threats identified and mitigated.	Top-three threats and mitigations; confirmation that secret scanning was switched on.
Responsible	Data used lawfully and within its licence; personal data kept to a minimum (GDPR); AI use disclosed and its limits stated; basic accessibility for user interfaces (WCAG 2.2 level AA where practical).	Data sources and licences; AI-use statement; accessibility checks carried out; known limitations.
Efficient	Models and infrastructure sized to the problem; no needless compute; the core flow survives one component failing.	Reason for the model and infrastructure choices; optional energy estimate (for example with the open-source CodeCarbon tool); a note on single points of failure.

Trust Card: one page, six questions

1. **Data:** What data do you use, where is it from, what licence applies, and does it include personal data?
2. **AI:** Where does the product use AI, and which AI tools did you use to build it?
3. **Risks:** What are your top three security, privacy or misuse risks, and how have you reduced them?
4. **Accessibility:** What accessibility checks have you done?
5. **Efficiency and resilience:** Why did you choose this model or infrastructure, and what happens if one part fails?
6. **Limits:** What does the prototype not do yet, and what is mocked or simulated?

6. Challenge domains

The reference event's 11 domains are kept so that the event stays broad and familiar. Each is re-scoped for Ireland and the EU, and a twelfth domain is added. The example problem statements show the intended level; the final statements will be written with mentors and sponsors and checked for data availability by Friday 18 December 2026.

SME Challenge Bank (new)

Because the summit's audience is SMEs, local businesses are invited, through the summit's community, to submit real problems they face. Each one is checked for scope, data and IP terms (teams keep their IP, section 10.3), tagged to one of the 12 domains, and published with the other problem statements.

Teams that choose an SME challenge get a short call with that business during Round 2. Projects are framed as practical tools an SME could use, and teams are encouraged to publish them as open source so summit attendees can try them.

#	Reference domain	IT Summit 2027 scope	Example problem statements	Open data and resources
1	Applied AI and Data Intelligence	Applied and Trustworthy AI, including AI agents	An assistant for student services that cites its sources; detecting AI-generated misinformation; a guarded AI agent for a routine business workflow.	data.gov.ie; data.europa.eu

#	Reference domain	IT Summit 2027 scope	Example problem statements	Open data and resources
2	Agritech and Food Safety (IoT/Software)	Agritech and Food Safety (IoT/Software)	A low-cost soil-moisture or grass-growth sensor; farm-to-fork traceability; reducing food waste in campus catering.	Met Éireann open data; Copernicus Earth observation data
3	Sustainability and Climate Action	Sustainability, Climate Action and Green Software	Home energy-use insights; a carbon-aware scheduler that moves flexible computing jobs to lower-carbon hours; a campus energy dashboard.	CSO open data (PxStat); data.gov.ie
4	Digital Public Infrastructure	Digital Public Services and Digital Identity	A plain-language, accessible guide to a public service; a verifiable student credential using open standards; an open-data explorer for local authorities.	data.gov.ie; EU Digital Identity Wallet architecture and reference framework (public)
5	Healthcare Innovation (national digital health mission, IoT/Software)	Digital Health and Wellbeing (interoperability, IoT)	A referral or appointment prototype on the HL7 FHIR standard using synthetic data; student mental-health signposting; a privacy-by-design wearable.	HL7 FHIR specification; synthetic patient data (for example Synthea). No real patient data.
6	Cybersecurity and Privacy	Cybersecurity, Privacy and AI Security	Phishing and deepfake detection for small firms; a ransomware recovery drill tool; prompt-injection defences for an LLM app; a post-quantum cryptography inventory tool.	OWASP guidance; MITRE ATT&CK; NIST post-quantum standards
7	Smart Mobility and Logistics (IoT/Software)	Smart Mobility and Logistics (IoT/Software)	Predicting public-transport reliability; last-mile delivery route optimisation; a cycling-safety map.	National Transport Authority GTFS and GTFS-Realtime feeds (free API key); OpenStreetMap
8	EdTech and Skills Empowerment	EdTech and Skills	A study coach that cites course material and respects academic integrity; mapping skills gaps from job adverts; accessible lecture captioning.	Open course material; data.gov.ie
9	MSME Digitization and Commerce	SME Digitalisation and Commerce	An accessibility checker for small online shops (European Accessibility Act); invoice and receipt automation; a cyber-hygiene assistant for micro-businesses.	WCAG 2.2; CSO business statistics
10	Accessibility and Inclusive Tech	Accessibility and Inclusive Tech	Tools that support Irish Sign Language users; screen-reader-friendly campus navigation; simplifying complex forms.	WCAG 2.2; National Disability Authority guidance on the European Accessibility Act
11	Open Domain (Student Innovation)	Open Domain (Student Innovation)	Any idea that does not fit the other domains. The Trust Triad still applies.	Any lawful open data

#	Reference domain	IT Summit 2027 scope	Example problem statements	Open data and resources
12 (new)	Not in reference event	Optimisation, Cloud and Resilient Systems	A cloud cost-and-carbon optimiser (FinOps); a chaos-testing tool for a small microservice; a campus timetable or room-booking optimiser; an incident runbook assistant.	Open-source tools such as Kubernetes, Google OR-Tools, and Chaos Mesh or LitmusChaos

- **Hardware:** Domains 2, 5 and 7 allow IoT work. The reference event's hardware practice is kept: a published component list by Friday 5 February 2027, a kit issue-and-return log, and spare boards in the contingency kit. Teams may bring their own kits.
- **Domain prizes:** a domain prize is awarded only if at least three finalist teams compete in that domain. Otherwise the domain is merged into the general ranking, which stops a domain being won by default.

7. Rounds, format and master timeline

7.1 Round 1: idea submission (online)

- Opens **Monday 11 January 2027** and closes **Friday 29 January 2027 at 17:00 (Irish time)**. Three weeks is enough for a 6-slide idea deck, and no deadline falls on the St Brigid's Day bank holiday (Monday 1 February 2027).
- Deliverable: an idea deck of **no more than 6 slides including the title slide**, in PPTX or PDF, up to 10 MB, named TeamName_Institution_TeamID_Round1 (the reference event's convention). Full guidelines are in Appendix A, and a template is supplied.
- Judging: the reference event's five criteria at 20% each. Two screening judges score each deck; a third scores it if the first two differ by more than 20 points.
- Outcome: up to 50 teams shortlisted, announced **Friday 5 February 2027**.

7.2 Round 2: mentored build sprint (online) – new

- Runs **Monday 8 to Monday 15 February 2027 (12:00)**.
- Each shortlisted team has one 20-minute online mentor session, and teams working on an SME challenge also get a short call with that business.
- Deliverables: a 3-minute video (problem, architecture and an early proof of concept or clickable prototype), an architecture diagram, a draft Trust Card and the repository link.
- Why it is added: it tests feasibility before anyone travels, gives teams feedback early, and screens out "idea-only" teams, which reduces no-shows at the finale.
- Outcome: 25 to 30 finalist teams plus a waitlist of 5, announced **Friday 19 February 2027**. Teams confirm within 48 hours or their place passes to the waitlist.

7.3 Grand Finale: 24 hours on site

- **Saturday 27 to Sunday 28 February 2027** (planning assumption: the weekend before the summit).
- **Declared baseline:** teams continue from their Round 2 repository. At kick-off each team tags its repository ("finale-start"), so judges can see what was built on site. Any other pre-existing code, templates or libraries must be declared, in line with the reference event's originality policy.
- Mentor rounds and checkpoints at fixed times, two short workshops, an optional overnight mini-CTF, and a single hard deadline at H+24.

- **Summit showcase:** the winning and special-award teams present at the summit on **Thursday 4 March 2027** (planning assumption; see section 8.1).

7.4 Master timeline

The reference event's T-60 to T+30 plan is mapped onto real dates, planned backwards from the summit. T0 is the first day of the Grand Finale, Saturday 27 February 2027 (planning assumption). December is kept light because of semester 1 exams and the holidays, so problem statements are finalised before the break.

Date	T	Milestone	Lead workstream
By Fri 27 Nov 2026	T-92	Summit date confirmed with the summit organisers; concept approved; core team formed; finale venue on hold; draft budget; sponsor deck ready.	Convener and Volunteer Coordinator
Mon 30 Nov – Fri 11 Dec 2026	T-89 to T-78	Sponsor outreach; judges and mentors invited; SME Challenge Bank call sent to the summit's business community; rules, code of conduct, privacy notice and IP terms drafted; registration platform chosen and tested.	Sponsorship; Challenges and content; Data protection
Fri 18 Dec 2026	T-71	Problem statements, SME challenges, datasets and website final; legal review of rules and IP terms complete.	Challenges and content
Mid Dec 2026 – early Jan 2027		Pause for exams and holidays. Only sponsor follow-ups continue.	Sponsorship
Mon 11 Jan 2027	T-47	Launch: registration and Round 1 open; outreach starts with Mid-West institutions and then goes national, through campus ambassadors.	Marketing; Registration
Wed 20 Jan 2027	T-38	Online information session and team-formation mixer.	Registration
Fri 29 Jan 2027	T-29	Round 1 closes at 17:00.	Registration
Fri 5 Feb 2027	T-22	Shortlist announced; venue, catering and sponsors confirmed; hardware list published.	Mentors and judging; Hospitality
Mon 8 – Mon 15 Feb 2027	T-19 to T-12	Round 2 build sprint and mentor sessions, including calls with SMEs for SME challenges.	Mentors and judging
Fri 19 Feb 2027	T-8	Finalists announced; 48-hour confirmation; waitlist active; summit-day attendance confirmed; volunteer training session 1.	Registration; Safety and volunteers
Mon 22 – Fri 26 Feb 2027	T-5 to T-1	Final week: reconfirm vendors, guests, judges and mentors; rehearse registration, A/V and the submission platform; Wi-Fi load test; volunteer briefing; venue set-up.	All
Sat 27 – Sun 28 Feb 2027	T0	Grand Finale.	All
By Wed 3 Mar 2027	T+4	Feedback forms; thank-you messages; venue handover; showcase materials ready.	Registration; Marketing

Date	T	Milestone	Lead workstream
Thu 4 Mar 2027	T+5	Limerick IT Summit: winners' showcase, SME Choice voting and prize presentation on the main stage.	Volunteer Coordinator; Marketing
By Fri 12 Mar 2027	T+13	Prizes paid; certificates issued; results and highlights published.	Sponsorship and finance
By Wed 31 Mar 2027	T+32	Budget reconciled; final event report; sponsor impact report; lessons-learned review.	Convener and Volunteer Coordinator
April – May 2027		Six-week build-on sprint for winning and selected teams, including follow-up with interested SMEs.	Mentors and judging

8. Grand Finale run-of-show

This schedule is adapted from the reference event's sample 24-hour schedule. Hacking starts earlier than in the reference schedule because teams arrive with a shortlisted idea and a Round 2 prototype. The reference event's ceremonial items (lamp-lighting or invocation) are replaced by a short opening suited to an Irish university setting.

Time	Saturday 27 February 2027
07:30	Check-in: ID check, lanyards (including a "no photos" lanyard option), Wi-Fi and platform access, hardware log
09:00	Opening: welcome, theme and the Trust Triad, sponsors, rules, code of conduct and judging criteria
10:00	Orientation: problem-statement Q&A, introduction of mentors, helpdesk and channels; teams tag their repositories "finale-start"
11:00	Hacking starts (H+0)
13:00	Lunch
14:00	Lightning workshop 1 (30 minutes): securing LLM apps, based on the OWASP Top 10 for LLM Applications
15:00	Mentor round 1 and checkpoint 1: scope locked
18:00	Lightning workshop 2 (30 minutes): accessible interfaces with WCAG 2.2
19:00	Dinner
21:00	Mentor round 2 and checkpoint 2: core flow working; backup demo video recorded
23:30	Late-night snacks
00:00	Mini-CTF (90 minutes, optional, beginner-friendly, hosted on the open-source CTFd platform)

Time	Sunday 28 February 2027
01:30 – 06:30	Overnight build. Helpdesk, first aid and security on duty; quiet room and rest area open
07:00	Breakfast

Time	Sunday 28 February 2027
08:00	Mentor round 3: demo rehearsal
10:00	Submission portal opens
11:00	Code freeze and hard deadline (H+24): repository, deck, Trust Card and backup demo video
11:00 – 12:00	Submission checks (commit history, AI-use statement, completeness); judge briefing and calibration
12:00	Lunch
12:45 – 14:45	Panel judging: three panels in parallel, about 10 teams each; 7-minute pitch and demo plus 5 minutes of Q&A
15:00	Project expo and People's Choice voting; panels confirm their top two teams
15:30 – 16:30	Final round: the top 6 teams present to the final panel
16:30	Final deliberation (expo continues)
17:00	Closing: results, certificates, thanks to sponsors, mentors and volunteers, vote of thanks, group photo. Prizes are presented at the summit.
18:00	Event closes; check-out and venue handover

8.1 Summit day showcase (new)

The summit's own programme sets the times. The hackathon needs three things from it, to be agreed with the summit organisers: showcase tables, a short main-stage slot and a simple way for attendees to vote.

When	Summit day: Thursday 4 March 2027 (planning assumption)
Before doors open	Showcase tables set up for the winning and special-award teams (about 8 to 10 tables), each with a poster and QR codes for the demo, repository and Trust Card
Exhibition and networking breaks	Teams demo to SME owners and other attendees; SME Choice voting by QR code
Main-stage slot (time agreed with the organisers)	Three-minute pitches from the overall winners; presentation of prizes and the SME Choice award; thanks to sponsors and to the SMEs who set challenges
After the summit	Introductions between teams and interested SMEs for pilots, internships or further development

Finalists hear about summit day when they are shortlisted, and the organisers give them letters for their institutions to support attendance on a weekday. If a winning team cannot attend, its recorded pitch is played instead.

9. Judging and awards

9.1 Panels

- **Screening (Rounds 1 and 2):** academics, industry engineers and alumni, with two judges per submission.

- **Finale panels:** three panels of three judges (an industry engineer, an academic and a start-up founder or investor). Across the three panels there is at least one security or responsible-AI specialist. Reserve judges are confirmed in advance, as at the reference event.
- **Final panel:** five judges, keeping the reference event's mix of start-up, industry and academic leaders and adding an SME owner from the summit community and a security or AI-governance practitioner.

9.2 Rubric

Criterion	Rounds 1 and 2 (reference event, kept)	Finale (proposed)	What judges look for
Innovation and creativity	20%	20%	How original the idea is compared with existing solutions
Feasibility	20%	15%	Real-world applicability, data availability, cost and adoption barriers
Technical depth and quality	20%	25%	A working demo, sound architecture, code quality, and what was built on site. Replaces "quantity of architecture/code".
Impact	20%	15%	Societal or industrial value, target users and ability to scale
Presentation and teamwork	20%	15%	Clarity, Q&A, and whether every member can explain their part
Trust Triad (secure, responsible, efficient)	Covered on slide 6 of the idea deck	10%	Evidence on the Trust Card
Total	100%	100%	

9.3 Scoring practice

- **Anchored scale:** each criterion is scored 1 to 5 against written descriptors and then weighted. This is quicker and more consistent than marking out of 100.
- **Calibration:** before scoring starts, all judges score one sample pitch video together and talk through their differences. This makes harsh and lenient judges more consistent.
- **Fair progression:** the top two teams from each parallel panel go through to the final round. Teams are never ranked across panels whose judges differ.
- **Conflict of interest:** judges declare any links to teams or institutions and do not score those teams (a reference event rule).
- **Tie-breakers:** the higher technical depth and quality score wins, then the higher impact score, then a vote of the final panel.
- **Appeals:** a written appeal can be made within 30 minutes of results. A named appeals panel (the convener and one judge with no conflict) decides within 60 minutes, and its decision is final.

9.4 Awards

Award	Basis
Overall winner, first runner-up and second runner-up	Final panel; announced at the finale, prizes presented at the summit
Domain awards	Only for domains with at least three finalist teams

Award	Basis
Best Trustworthy AI	Strongest responsible-AI evidence (Trust Card and Q&A)
Security-by-Design award	Best threat analysis and security implementation
Green Code award	Best efficiency and resilience choices, with evidence
Inclusive Design award	Best accessibility and inclusive design
People's Choice	Votes from participants and visitors at the finale expo
SME Choice award (new)	Votes from SME owners and other attendees at the summit showcase
Mini-CTF champions	Top scorers in the overnight capture-the-flag

Prize values are agreed with sponsors and published before Round 1 closes.

10. Rules, intellectual property and compliance in Ireland

10.1 Core participant rules

- Participants are aged 18 or over and enrolled at a higher-education institution in Ireland. Eligibility is checked with an institutional email address or student ID.
- Teams have 2 to 4 members, and each person can join only one team. Team changes are allowed up to the Round 2 deadline with organiser approval.
- Originality: the work must be the team's own. Pre-existing code, templates and libraries are allowed only if declared, and open-source licences must be respected.
- Data: open, synthetic or self-collected data only, with consent. No real patient data, and no personal data collected without consent.
- One hard deadline with a published grace policy that applies to everyone. If an outage happens, the deadline is extended by the length of the outage and the change is announced to all teams (a reference event practice).
- Everyone follows the code of conduct, which is published at registration and repeated at the opening.
- Finalists are asked to keep summit day free (Thursday 4 March 2027, planning assumption) to show their project. Attending is encouraged but is not a condition of winning.

10.2 Declared-AI policy (new)

- **Allowed:** AI coding assistants, chat assistants, and AI models and APIs, within their terms of service.
- **Required:** an "AI Use Statement" in the README listing the tools used and what they were used for. Any AI features in the product are disclosed to its users.
- **Checked:** judges may ask any team member to explain any part of the code. If the team cannot explain its core functionality, its technical depth score is lowered.
- **Not allowed:** passing off another team's work or an existing project as new work, or using pre-built code without declaring it. Either can lead to disqualification by the appeals panel.

10.3 Intellectual property

The reference event used IP shared between students and its host incubator, which then offered to incubate and scale projects through its ecosystem. For an inter-university event in Ireland this plan proposes:

- **Teams keep ownership** of everything they create.
- By entering, teams give the organisers a **non-exclusive licence** to show project names, descriptions, images and demo videos for event promotion and reporting.
- **Sponsor challenges** with different IP terms must publish those terms before registration opens, and entering them is optional.
- **Incubation stays available but is never a condition of entry:** interested teams are introduced to campus incubators and national programmes after the event (section 15).
- The final wording should be reviewed by the host institution's legal or technology-transfer office, because institutional IP policies can apply to students.

10.4 Organiser compliance checklist

Area	Action	Owner
Data protection (GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018)	Privacy notice at registration; collect only what is needed; access limited to named organisers using multi-factor authentication; delete participant data 12 months after the event unless people opt in to an alumni list; data-protection screening with the host institution's Data Protection Officer.	Data protection and accessibility lead
Photos and video	Consent captured at registration; a "no photos" lanyard colour; photographer and social-media volunteers briefed.	Marketing and PR
Code of conduct and safeguarding	Published anti-harassment code; named contacts; a reporting form; women volunteers on the night shift (a reference event practice); 18+ only. If under-18s are ever admitted: parental consent, child-safeguarding obligations, and Garda vetting of volunteers through the host institution.	Safety and volunteers
Accessibility	Step-free venue and accessible toilets; captions for main-stage sessions where possible; a quiet room (a reference event practice); access and dietary needs asked at registration.	Data protection and accessibility lead
Food	The caterer provides information on the 14 regulated allergens (EU Regulation 1169/2011); vegetarian, vegan, halal and gluten-free options; water stations.	Hospitality and logistics
Insurance and venue	Confirm the host institution's public-liability cover; get written approval for overnight use of the building; security staff contract; fire-safety briefing.	Convener
Alcohol	Alcohol-free event.	Convener
Sponsor credentials	Cloud credits and API keys issued per team, with spending caps and expiry dates, and revoked after the event.	Technical and platforms
Weather and travel	Monitor Met Éireann weather warnings and transport notices. The convener decides 24 hours ahead whether to switch to an online finale if a Status Red warning is issued.	Convener

11. Organisation, workstreams and volunteers

The reference event's team structure is kept and three workstreams are added. The faculty or host convener holds approvals and final decisions. The Volunteer Coordinator runs the workstreams day to day, recruits and trains volunteers, chairs a weekly stand-up (daily in the final week) and escalates

issues to the convener. Because the summit itself is volunteer-driven, the Volunteer Coordinator also links the hackathon volunteers with the summit's own team.

Workstream	Responsible for	Origin
Convener and core	Approvals, decisions, escalation, budget authority	Reference event
Volunteer Coordinator (Mohit Behl)	Coordinating all workstreams, volunteer recruitment and training, shift rota, stand-ups, run-of-show ownership, liaison with the summit organisers and the summit-day showcase	Role for IT Summit 2027
Registration and participants	Platform, screening, communications, check-in, kits, participant handbook	Reference event
Technical and platforms	Internet, power, platforms, helpdesk, submissions, A/V, sponsor credentials	Reference event
Mentors and judging	Selection, rubric, calibration, schedule, scoring, Round 2 mentor sessions	Reference event
Sponsorship and finance	Sponsors, budget, prizes, payments, sponsor report	Reference event
Hospitality and logistics	Food, venue, guests, travel and accommodation information	Reference event
Marketing and PR	Branding, outreach to every institution, social media, photography	Reference event
Safety and volunteers	Security, first aid, conduct, night shifts	Reference event
Challenges and content	Problem statements, datasets, workshops, mini-CTF	New
Data protection and accessibility	Privacy notice, data-protection screening, consent, accessibility	New
Event operations room	Live tracker for check-in, mentor queue, incidents and timings; incident log; on-duty incident lead for each shift	New

11.1 Finale volunteer rota (planning estimate)

Role	Per day shift	Overnight shift
Registration desk	4	0
Helpdesk and technical	3	2
Mentor queue and runners	2	1
Hospitality	3	1
Safety and first aid (trained)	2	2
Photography and social media	1	0
Operations room	1	1
Total on duty	16	7

Allowing for rest breaks and three shifts, recruit about **35 volunteers**. Each shift has a named lead, and at least two women volunteers are on the overnight shift. Training: session 1 at T-8 (roles, code of conduct, safeguarding, data protection) and a walk-through at the venue at T-1. On summit day, about 6 volunteers run the showcase tables, SME Choice voting and stage logistics, alongside the summit's own team.

12. Budget and sponsorship framework

No costs are estimated here: amounts depend on the venue, in-kind support and supplier quotes. The summit is free to attend and run on a non-profit basis, so the hackathon follows the same model: free entry, in-kind support wherever possible, and sponsorship aimed at prizes, food and travel bursaries. The structure below follows the reference event's practice of an itemised budget, an expense tracker and a 10 to 15% contingency.

Budget line	Main cost driver	How to estimate
Venue	Rooms for opening, building, mentoring, judging, rest and dining	Often provided in kind by the host; confirm any charges for out-of-hours use and security
Catering	Headcount × meals	About 185 people at peak (up to 120 finalists, about 35 volunteers, about 20 mentors and judges, about 10 guests) × 6 meal and snack points, from caterer quotes
Internet and power	Backup line, extension boards, charging points, UPS	Host IT quote; hire costs
A/V and streaming	Projectors, microphones, sound, cameras, live stream	Host A/V team or hire quote
Print and merchandise	ID lanyards, signage, certificates, trophies, kits	Unit price × quantity
Prizes	Cash and in-kind prizes	Agreed with sponsors
Hardware	IoT kits and spares for Domains 2, 5 and 7	Component list × expected IoT teams, plus 20% spares
Security and first aid	Overnight security, first-aid cover	Contractor or host quote
Travel bursaries (new, optional)	Support for finalists travelling from other regions	Fixed fund, allocated on application
Contingency	Unplanned costs	10 to 15% of the total (reference event practice)

12.1 Sponsorship tiers

Tier	Typical contribution	Benefits
Title partner	The largest cash contribution	Named in the event title line; keynote slot; own sponsor challenge; a seat on the final panel; recruitment booth; logo on all materials; opt-in CV book (with participant consent under GDPR)
Gold	Cash or prize funding	Lightning workshop slot; booth; mentor team; logo on website and stage slides
Silver	Smaller cash or prize funding	Logo; shared booth space; mentors
Community and in-kind	Cloud credits, APIs, hardware, food, merchandise	Logo and thanks on stage

As at the reference event, signed agreements list exactly what each sponsor provides (cash, credits, APIs, prizes, merchandise, mentors, stands) and are signed before Friday 5 February 2027. Existing summit partners are approached first, so sponsors see one joined-up offer rather than two separate requests. Sponsor challenges must respect the Trust Triad and the IP terms in section 10.3.

13. Risks and contingency plan

The reference event's contingency plan is kept in full (marked "Ref"). New risks (marked "New") reflect the issues described in section 4.

Risk	Prevention	Fallback	Source
Internet fails	Backup line; separate event Wi-Fi network; load test in the final week	Hotspots; extend the deadline by the length of the outage and announce it	Ref
Power fails	Check the UPS and generator	Spare extension boards and charging points	Ref
Submission platform goes down	Test it; open submissions 60 minutes early	Backup by email or shared drive, checked by timestamp	Ref
A judge is absent	Confirm reserve judges	Reserve judges or mentors step in	Ref
Dispute or complaint	Clear rules; a briefing at the opening	Named appeals panel with a time limit	Ref
Medical or safety incident	First-aid cover; emergency numbers displayed	First aid; emergency list; incident log	Ref
Late submissions	Countdown announcements	The published grace policy applies to everyone	Ref
Cloud or AI API outage, or rate limits, during hacking	Teams cache and mock key services and record a backup demo video by checkpoint 2	Judges accept the recorded demo and a code walk-through, with no penalty for a provider outage	New
Phishing or scam messages aimed at participants	Publish the official channels; state that organisers never ask for passwords or payments	Warning posted by the operations room; reports go to the helpdesk	New
API keys or secrets leaked	Per-team keys with spending caps; secret scanning recommended	Revoke and reissue the keys	New
Personal-data incident	Minimal data; access controls; multi-factor authentication	Follow the host institution's breach procedure; inform its Data Protection Officer immediately (GDPR sets a 72-hour deadline for notifying the Data Protection Commission where required)	New
Disputes over AI use or undeclared prior work	Declared-AI policy; "finale-start" repository tag; commit history check	Appeals panel review	New
Severe weather or transport disruption	Monitor Met Éireann warnings; publish travel information	Switch to an online finale or adjust deadlines	New
High no-show rate (the reference event expects 15 to 30%)	Round 2 filters for commitment; 48-hour confirmation	Waitlist of 5 teams	Ref + New

Risk	Prevention	Fallback	Source
Low registrations from some institutions	Campus ambassadors and student-society partners at each institution	Targeted outreach in the final week of Round 1	New
Summit date not yet confirmed, or it changes	Plan every date relative to the summit; confirm the date by 27 November 2026	Shift all dates by the same amount; the finale stays on the weekend before the summit	New
Winning teams cannot attend the weekday summit	Tell finalists about summit day at shortlisting; letters for their institutions	Play the team's recorded pitch at the showcase	New

14. Participant journey and communications

This section uses the reference event's participant-journey report to decide what support the organisers give at each stage.

Stage	What participants do	What IT Summit 2027 provides
Discover and register	Check eligibility, theme, rules and dates; form a team; register	Website with all dates; FAQ; campus ambassadors; online information session (20 January)
Form a team	Cover the four roles; agree tools and how they will work	Team-formation mixer and matching channel; four-role guidance
Round 1	Research the problem; write the 6-slide idea deck	Template and guidelines (Appendix A); office hours on the helpdesk
Shortlist and Round 2	Mentor call; 3-minute video; draft Trust Card	Mentor booking; written feedback
Before the finale	Plan travel; pack; set up accounts and repository	Participant handbook: venue, schedule, packing list, Wi-Fi, hardware list, code of conduct
Finale	Build, attend mentor rounds and checkpoints, rest	Helpdesk; mentor queue; workshops; quiet room and rest area; meals
Judging	Pitch, demo, Q&A	Clear timings; backup demo policy; equipment check
Summit day (new)	Demo to SMEs; winners pitch on the main stage	Showcase table; stage slot; SME Choice voting; letters for institutions
After the event	Feedback; certificates; keep building	Certificates; results; build-on sprint; SME introductions; alumni community

14.1 Channels

- **Website:** the single source of truth for rules, dates and FAQs.
- **Shared event mailbox:** for official notices and private questions. It is role-based, not a personal address.
- **Community server** (for example Discord): #announcements, #helpdesk, #mentor-queue and #team-formation. The reference event used Discord, Slack or WhatsApp.

- **Packing list** (from the reference event): laptop, charger, student ID, phone, permitted peripherals, required software and accounts, backup files. Add a travel adapter for visiting international students; Ireland uses Type G sockets.

15. After the event: follow-up and success measures

15.1 Follow-up

When	Tasks
T0 to T+4 (by Wed 3 Mar 2027)	Feedback forms for participants, mentors, judges and volunteers; attendance records; venue handover and logistics settlement; photos and videos sorted; thank-you messages
T+5 to T+13 (Thu 4 to Fri 12 Mar 2027)	Summit showcase and prize presentation; prize and supplier payments tracked; certificates and follow-up email; results, highlights and press release
T+14 to T+32 (by Wed 31 Mar 2027)	Budget reconciliation and expense report; final event report; sponsor report on reach and impact; lessons-learned review; plans for the next edition
April – May 2027 (new)	Six-week build-on sprint: fortnightly mentor check-ins for winning and selected teams, and follow-up with SMEs that showed interest at the summit

Pathways after the event: interested teams are introduced to campus incubators and enterprise offices, and to Enterprise Ireland's New Frontiers entrepreneur development programme, which runs through Technological Universities and institutes across the country (intake dates vary by location). Teams are encouraged to publish their code under an open-source licence and to keep their repositories maintained.

15.2 Success measures

The reference event tracked attendance against registrations, submissions, satisfaction scores, prototypes continued, sponsor satisfaction, budget variance and incident count. These are kept, and diversity, reach and SME-engagement measures are added. Targets are proposals for a first edition.

Measure	Proposed target	How it is measured
Finalist attendance compared with confirmations	90% or more	Check-in records
Finalist teams that demo a working prototype	80% or more	Judging records
Institutions represented in Round 1	8 or more	Registration data
Women and non-binary participants	30% or more	Optional, anonymous diversity question
Participant satisfaction	Average of 4 out of 5 or higher	Post-event survey
Serious safety or data incidents	Zero	Incident log
Budget variance	Within ±10%	Final reconciliation
Projects still active after 30 days	25% or more	Repository activity
Sponsor satisfaction and intention to return	4 out of 5 or higher	Sponsor survey

Measure	Proposed target	How it is measured
Trust Cards completed by finalists	100%	Submission checks
SME challenges in the Challenge Bank	10 or more	Challenge Bank records
Teams continuing with an SME (pilot, internship or follow-up) within 3 months	3 or more	Follow-up survey

16. Decisions needed and next steps

The following decisions are requested from the organising committee by **Friday 27 November 2026**:

1. Confirm the 2027 summit date with the summit organisers, and agree a showcase area and a main-stage slot for the hackathon winners.
2. Approve the concept, the three-round format and the finale weekend (planning assumption: Saturday 27 to Sunday 28 February 2027), or choose the Plan B format.
3. Confirm the finale venue and whether overnight use of the building is permitted.
4. Approve the IP terms and the declared-AI policy, subject to legal or technology-transfer review.
5. Appoint the faculty convener and the leads of the 10 workstreams.
6. Approve a budget envelope and the sponsorship tiers, and authorise sponsor outreach.
7. Approve the 12 domains and the SME Challenge Bank, and name a domain owner for each to vet problem statements by Friday 18 December 2026.

Prepared by

Mohit Behl, Volunteer Coordinator, IT Summit 2027

Contact: the shared event mailbox, to be set up once the committee approves this plan

Appendix A. Round 1 idea submission guidelines (IT Summit 2027 version)

This appendix adapts the reference event's guidelines. Changes are marked "new".

Overview

In Round 1, teams submit a short presentation that explains the problem, the proposed solution, what makes it unique, its likely impact, and (new) how feasible and trustworthy it is. **Maximum: 6 slides, including the title slide.**

1. Format

- File type: PPTX or PDF only. Use the IT Summit 2027 template if possible.
- Slide limit: 6 slides including the title slide. Extra slides are not judged.
- Design: clean, simple visuals with bullet points rather than paragraphs. Use diagrams and charts where they help.

2. Mandatory slide structure

Slide	Content
1. Title	Team name; member names, year, programme and institution; project or idea name; domain number (1–12) and SME challenge ID if you chose one; optional logo or concept image. Do not put phone numbers on slides: contact details are collected securely in the registration form (new).
2. Problem statement	A clear definition of the problem; why it matters; supporting statistics or facts, with sources.
3. Proposed solution	The idea in simple terms; how it solves the problem; key features; basic technology stack or approach.
4. Innovation and uniqueness	How it differs from existing solutions; technical, creative or business innovations.
5. Impact and target users	Who benefits; expected social, technical or commercial outcomes.
6. Feasibility and trust (new)	Data sources and licences; AI use (in the product and in building it); top risks for security, privacy or misuse and how you will reduce them; what you will build in Round 2.

3. File naming

TeamName_Institution_TeamID_Round1 (for example, ByteForge_InstitutionName_T042_Round1).

4. Submission

- Deadline: Friday 29 January 2027 at 17:00 (Irish time). Dates for all rounds are on the event website from launch.
- Method: upload through the registration platform. File size limit: 10 MB.

5. Evaluation criteria (each 20%)

- Innovation and creativity: how original the idea is.
- Feasibility: real-world applicability.
- Presentation quality: clarity and structure.
- Technical potential: depth and practicality.
- Impact: societal or industrial value.

6. Important notes

- Keep to the slide limit. Slides beyond the sixth are not judged.
- No plagiarism: credit all sources, images and third-party assets.
- AI tools may be used to prepare the deck. Say so on slide 6 (new).
- Write for a mixed jury of industry and academic experts.
- Queries: the event mailbox or the #helpdesk channel.

Appendix B. Logistics and infrastructure checklist

Adapted from the reference event's planning report, with notes for Ireland.

Area	Must-do (reference event)	Irish and IT Summit 2027 additions
Venue	Halls for the opening, building, mentoring, judging, rest, dining and registration; seating plan, signage and decoration; washrooms open 24 hours; sleeping zone	Written approval for overnight use; step-free access; a quiet room; a prayer or reflection room if available
Internet and power	Bandwidth for every device plus a backup line; extension boards, charging points, generator	A separate event Wi-Fi network for guests without eduroam access; Type G adapters at the helpdesk
Equipment	Projectors, microphones, sound, cameras, live stream; hardware kits with an issue-and-return log; sponsor credits and API keys shared early	Per-team keys with spending caps and expiry
Platforms	Submission platform tested; channels for announcements, questions and mentor requests	Multi-factor authentication on organiser accounts; least-privilege access to participant data
Food and guests	Caterer, meals, late-night snacks, drinking water, dietary needs; guest hospitality; transport and accommodation for guests from elsewhere	Allergen information; late-night transport information; optional travel bursaries
Print and merchandise	ID cards, kits, certificates, trophies, prizes, score sheets, signage	"No photos" lanyard colour; digital certificates to cut printing
Safety	First aid, nearby hospital, emergency numbers; marked exits, extinguishers, ID-based entry log, overnight security, lost and found	Weather-warning check 24 hours ahead; incident log in the operations room
Final week	Reconfirm everyone; rehearse registration, A/V, Wi-Fi and the submission platform; brief volunteers; prepare the run-of-show, contact sheet and contingency kit	Calibration video for judges ready; phishing warning sent to all finalists

Appendix C. Sources and verification notes

Facts in section 4 and elsewhere were checked against these public sources on 4 November 2026. Several are secondary reports; regulatory dates in particular should be re-checked against official texts before participant materials are published.

Proposed dates were checked against the 2027 calendar: St Brigid's Day bank holiday is Monday 1 February, St Patrick's Day is Wednesday 17 March, and Easter Sunday is 28 March 2027. Institution-specific term, reading-week and exam dates must be confirmed with the host. The 2027 summit date had not been announced; this plan

assumes Thursday 4 March 2027, based on previous editions on Thursday 6 March 2025 and Thursday 26 February 2026.

Reference event materials (anonymised)

- Event website screenshots: domains 1–11, final judging panel, IP policy, judging parameters.
- Round 1 idea submission guidelines and ideation slide template.
- Hackathon planning report and participant journey report.
- The reference event's live website and a shared link (share.google) could not be accessed from the drafting environment; only the screenshots provided were used.

Host event: Limerick IT Summit (public coverage; the summit website could not be opened)

- First summit, 6 March 2025 (Limerick City and County Council): https://www.limerick.ie/business/news-events/news/limericks-first-it-summit-explodes-onto-the-scene-on-march-6th
- 2025 summit format and organisers (Limerick Post): https://www.limerickpost.ie/2025/02/28/limerick-it-summit-explodes-into-being-in-march/
- 2026 summit, venue and capacity (Limerick Post): https://www.limerickpost.ie/2026/02/21/limerick-it-summit-returns-building-connections-driving-innovation/
- 2026 summit listing (Limerick City and County Council): https://www.limerick.ie/discover/whats-on/festivals/limerick-it-summit-2026
- 2026 registration, "Your AI Toolkit" (Eventbrite): https://www.eventbrite.ie/e/limerick-it-summit-your-ai-toolkit-tickets-1981555856910
- Summit coverage (Limerick Leader): https://www.limerickleader.ie/news/business/business-event-is-a-major-stepping-stone-for-limericks-digital-future-6896252

Regulation and policy

- EU AI Act high-risk delay (Digital Omnibus): https://www.jdsupra.com/legalnews/eu-legislators-agree-to-delay-for-high-5617765/
- AI Act Digital Omnibus agreement: https://www.winstontaylor.com/insights/ai-act-rules-on-high-risk-ai-delayed-as-ai-digital-omnibus-agreed
- Ireland referred to CJEU over NIS2: https://www.lawsociety.ie/gazette/top-stories/2026/july/ireland-referred-to-cjeu-over-cyber-bill/
- Government pledge on delayed cyber bill: https://www.lawsociety.ie/gazette/top-stories/2026/october/government-pledge-on-delayed-cyber-bill/
- Cyber Resilience Act reporting (European Commission): https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/cra-reporting
- European Accessibility Act in Ireland (CCPC): https://www.ccpc.ie/business/european-accessibility-act-becomes-law-in-ireland-on-28-june-2025/
- European Accessibility Act (National Disability Authority): https://nda.ie/eaa
- EU Digital Identity Wallet: https://www.lexisnexis.com/en-gb/legal/news/the-eu-digital-identity-wallet-what-companies-need-to-know
- Ireland's EU Council Presidency priorities: https://epthinktank.eu/2026/07/01/what-are-irelands-priorities-for-its-upcoming-presidency-of-the-council-of-the-eu/

Incidents and industry data

- HSE Conti cyber attack, independent review: https://www.hse.ie/eng/services/publications/conti-cyber-attack-on-the-hse-full-report.pdf
- Airport check-in cyber attack, September 2025: https://www.irishtimes.com/world/europe/2025/09/20/cyberattack-disrupts-operations-at-heathrow-and-other-european-airports
- Airport attack confirmed as ransomware: https://therecord.media/europe-airports-delays-ransomware-attack-checkin-systems
- AWS us-east-1 outage post-mortem summary: https://www.infoq.com/news/2025/11/aws-dynamodb-outage-postmortem
- July 2024 faulty update, 8.5 million devices (Microsoft): https://blogs.microsoft.com/blog/2024/07/20/helping-our-customers-through-the-crowdstrike-outage/

- Data centre electricity 2024 (CSO): https://www.cso.ie/en/releasesandpublications/ep/p-dcmec/datacentresmeteredelectricityconsumption2024/keyfindings/
- Data centre electricity 2025 (report on CSO data): https://www.irishexaminer.com/business/companies/arid-41875214.html
- NIST post-quantum standards: https://www.nist.gov/news-events/news/2024/08/nist-releases-first-3-finalized-post-quantum-encryption-standards
- OWASP Top 10 for LLM Applications: https://genai.owasp.org/llm-top-10/
- WCAG 2.2: https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/

Data, tools and programmes referenced

- NTA developer portal (GTFS-Realtime): https://developer.nationaltransport.ie/
- Irish open data portal: https://data.gov.ie/
- EU open data portal: https://data.europa.eu/
- Enterprise Ireland New Frontiers: https://www.enterprise-ireland.com/en/news/new-frontiers-networking-event-brings-together-158-founders
- CodeCarbon (energy estimation): https://codecarbon.io/
- CTFd (open-source CTF platform): https://ctfd.io/